## Advisory

Advisory: Severity Ladder for advisories.

Incident notes used incompatible words for how urgent a fix was.

Findings: Severity Ladder maps outage of a control path to high, degraded visibility to medium, and documentation drift to low.

Using the ladder cut disagreements between the two duty officers from 14 cases to 3 cases in April.

Recommended posture: Label operational notes with the ladder and keep vendor wording only as a quotation..

## Assessment

Assessment method: Two duty officers labeled 40 historical notes independently, then repeated the task with the ladder definitions in view.

Observed outcome: Agreement rose from 65 percent to 92 percent after the ladder was introduced.

Boundaries: The ladder does not score vulnerabilities that have no operational impact note.

Unresolved items: Should customer-visible delay without an outage sit at medium or at high? Exposure: Severity medium: Copying a vendor's own urgency word can bypass the ladder and reintroduce inconsistent labels.

Recommended action: Record the ladder label next to any vendor wording and use the ladder label in briefs..